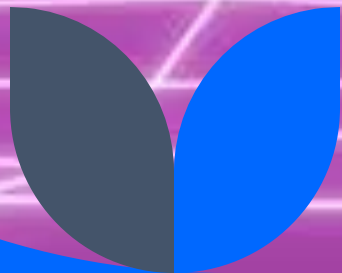




Economic Impact of Video Games: A Big Data Approach Using Global Sales Data

Vasco Silva-1240499

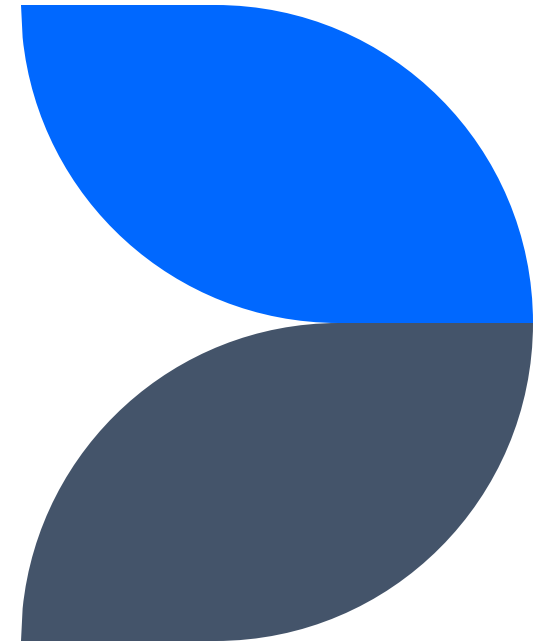


Context & Objectives

- Video games evolved into a multi-billion dollar global industry
- Traditional analysis struggles with scale, heterogeneity, and temporal depth
- Objective: **design and validate a Big Data pipeline** to analyze long-term industry trends

Literature Review

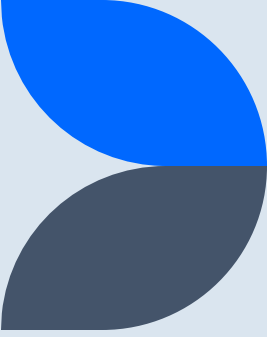
- Prior studies focus on:
 - Console life cycles
 - Genre dominance
 - Regional markets
- Industry reports (Newzoo, Visual Capitalist) show revenue growth but lack transparent pipelines
- **Gap:** Limited reproducible, scalable analytical pipelines



Dataset Overview

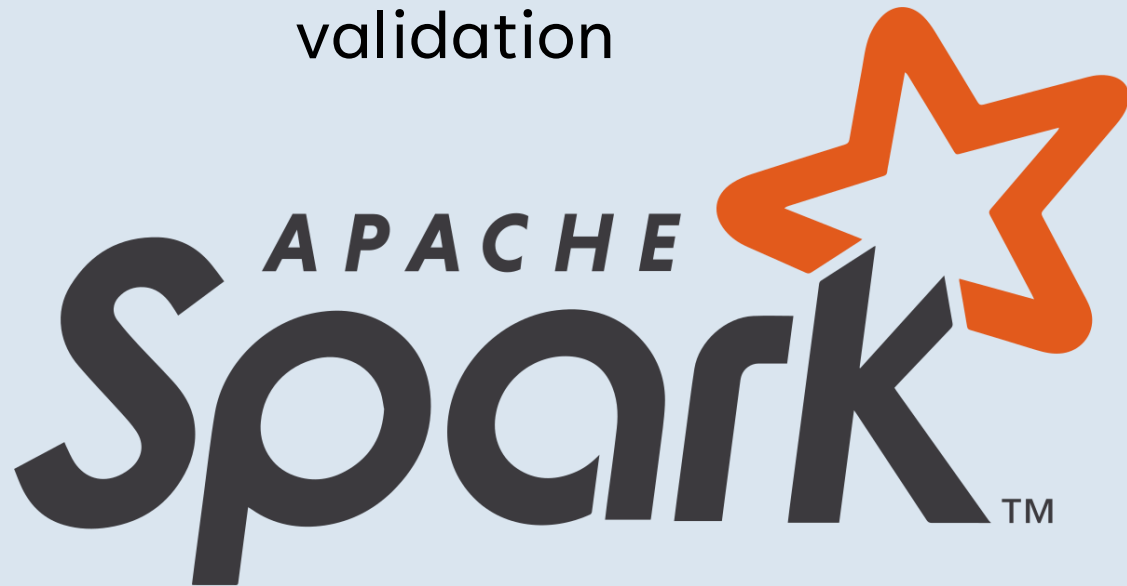
- Source: Video Game Sales (1978–2024)
- Records: ~70k
- Key attributes:
 - Year, Platform, Genre
 - Regional sales (NA, PAL, JP, Other)
 - Global sales
- Physical sales bias
- No mobile-first revenue

Apache Spark and Colab



- Distributed processing
- Scales beyond pandas
- Built-in aggregation & validation

- Reproducible
- No local environment issues
- Adequate for batch analytics



Lakehouse Architecture



Validation Strategy

Incremental validation

Hard Rules

Soft Rules

No over-cleaning

Regional vs global sales consistency

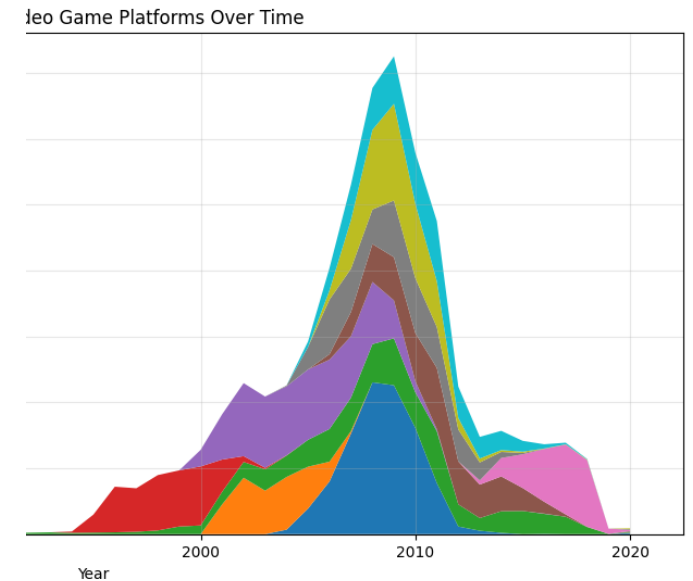
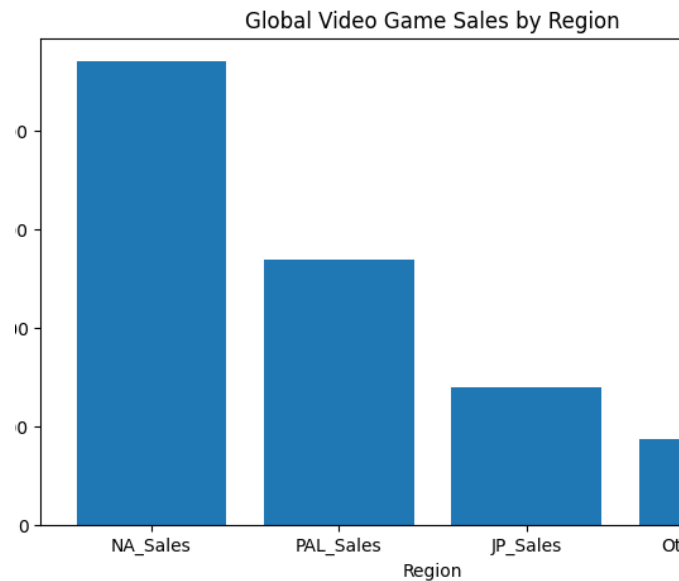
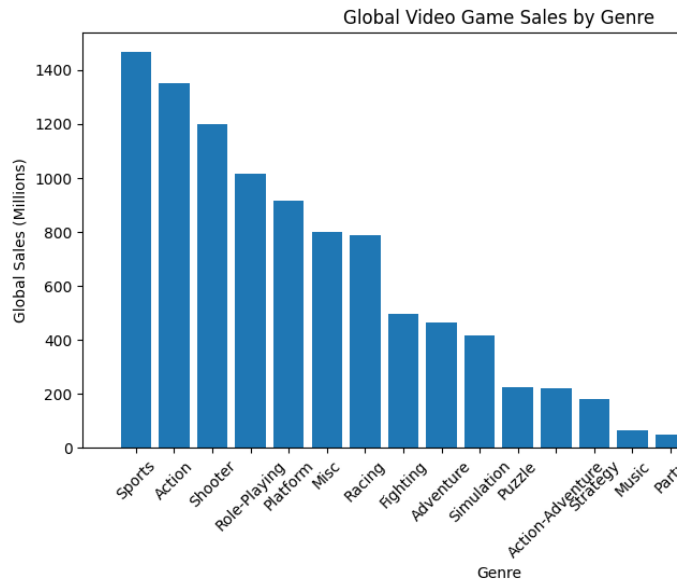
Duplicate Removal

Platform Normalization

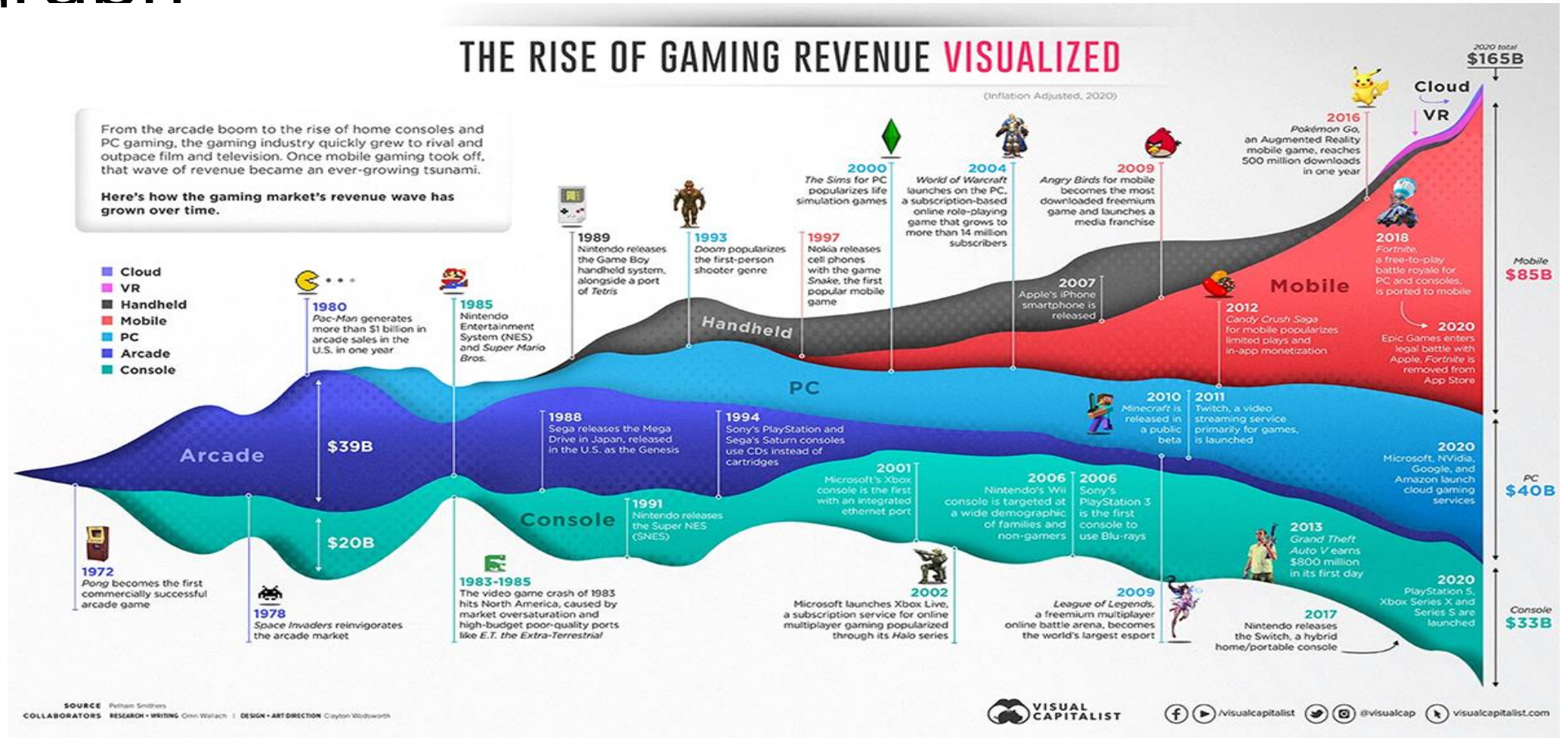
Results: Global Trends



Platform & Genre Dynamics



Comparison with External Industry Graph



Limitations & Trade-offs

- No inflation adjustment
- Physical sales bias
- Platform metadata inconsistency

Thank you